

The Verses That Bring About Well-Being

Svastyayana Gāthā · Toh 818 · Derge Kangyur

བད་ལེགས་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་སྤྱུང་པ་

The Verses That Bring About Well-Being, in Sanskrit Svastyayana Gāthā and in Tibetan Bde legs kyi tshigs su bcad pa, is a short devotional and auspicious text in verse. It begins when a god asks the Buddha how a person may always be blessed with well-being, and the Buddha answers with a series of stanzas describing the kinds of conduct and faith through which well-being arises everywhere. The opening verses name unshakable faith in the Tathāgata and virtuous, morally disciplined living as sources of such blessing, and the text closes by invoking the power of truth: if these words are true, may great happiness and well-being follow. It is Toh 818 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the general class of auspicious verses and protective or blessing texts.

...Thus, if this word of mine is truly the supreme truth,
by this truth may there be great happiness and well-being.

Here ends the verses of well-being.

In the language of India: Svastyayana Gāthā. In the language of Tibet: The Verses That Bring About Well-Being.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

A certain god approached the Guide of the World and said:

"Blessed One, I ask you this: by what means may one be always blessed with well-being?"

Having heard these words, the Guide of the World, the Holy One, gave this teaching:

"O god, listen well to how well-being comes about everywhere.

Those whose faith in the Tathāgata is unshakable, firmly and well established,
those who are virtuous and keep to moral discipline,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who always serve and honor well
their father and mother, their sons and daughters, and their servants,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who, with firm faith, make offerings to the renowned arhats
and who act in accord with the god's instruction,

for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who are free of wrongdoing in body, speech, and mind,
those who have thoroughly restrained all three,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who, toward all beings, boundlessly and without disturbance,
cultivate a mind of loving-kindness,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who, in order to abandon all suffering,
well cultivate the eightfold noble path,
which leads to happiness,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who always see well the emptiness of all conditioned things,
and who have become established in this within the mind,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who, having directly realized the stainless nature of the body, go about
freely,
arhats who possess a liberated mind,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who are free from attachment, aversion, and delusion,
and free of clinging,
in whom undisturbed wisdom has arisen,
for them well-being comes everywhere.

Those who, as the protector of the world with its gods..."

The passage breaks off here, mid-verse.

Translator's Notes

- The passage begins and ends mid-text; the opening lines are the close of a preceding verse, and the final verse is truncated, so I have rendered it as incomplete rather than guess the ending. In the verse on arhats, the phrase "the god's instruction" (lha yi bka') is unclear; it may refer to the Buddha's command, or it may reflect a corruption in the text, since "the Blessed One's word" would fit the context better. The verse beginning "those who, having directly realized the stainless nature of the body" is difficult; the reading "body" (lus) may be a textual error, and I have followed the received text. In the first verse, the Tibetan has the god asking in the first person, while the opening request is attributed to the Blessed One in the line "bdag gis zhu yis bcom ldan gsungs"; I have read it as the god's question addressed to the Blessed One.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.